STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-5400
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 08/13/07	DATE REVISED **05/15/15**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: SEARCH AND RESCUE UNIT	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT CRITERIA FOR SEARCH AND RESCUE UNIT ACTIVATION		CROSS REFERENCE P-3432 EMERGENCY MEDICAL HELICOPTER P-5100 MISSING PERSONS P-6600 CRITERIA FOR K-9 UNIT ACTIVATION		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for activating the Search and Rescue Unit.

II. Policy:

The Sheriff's Office shall provide a professionally trained and maintained Search and Rescue Unit (SARU) to assist in the daily operations of all divisions. The SARU shall be available twenty-four (24) hours a day for emergency situations that may require coordinated search efforts or rescue efforts in hazardous conditions. Requests for immediate use of the SARU shall be made to the SARU Commander. If the SARU Commander is unavailable, requests shall be made through the SARU Team Leader. Deputies shall take care to prepare the incident scene for the arrival of the SARU according to the following procedures.

III. Procedure:

A. Requesting the Search and Rescue Unit:

1. Requests for the immediate services of the SARU by Sheriff's Office personnel shall be directed to the on-duty patrol supervisor. The supervisor shall determine if the SARU is required and, if so, shall have Communications notify the SARU Commander or SARU Team Leader. If the SARU is requested by a supervisor, the on-duty watch commander or the ADC shall be notified.

2. Requests from other agencies to utilize the SARU shall be directed to the SARU Commander.

3. The SARU Commander or Team Leader shall contact the requesting supervisor and determine if the SARU will respond. If the SARU Commander or Team Leader determines that the SARU will respond, Communications shall be notified to send a group page, including a contact number and a response location, to all team members.

4. Team members shall go "in service" on the L.E.West channel and then shall switch to the Search and Rescue channel unless advised by Communications.

B. **Missing Persons:** If a shift supervisor believes the SARU would be of assistance in locating a missing person (e.g. searching a large area, searching hazardous or difficult terrain, searching during severe weather conditions, etc.), the following procedures shall be adhered to:

1. The shift supervisor shall request the SARU as soon as possible.

2. If possible, deputies should not disturb the intended search area or destroy any possible tracks and, if known, deputies should note the last known location of the missing person. A K-9 team may also be requested to assist in the search (see P-6600 Criteria for K-9 Unit Activation).

3. See also P-5100 Missing Persons.

C. **Water/Ice Rescues:** If a shift supervisor believes the SARU would be of assistance in rescuing a person(s) from the water (e.g. capsized boat, drowning, victim fallen through the ice, etc.), the following procedures shall be adhered to:

1. The shift supervisor shall request the SARU as soon as possible.

2. No deputy should enter the water without securing all equipment (duty belt, ballistic vest, boots, etc.) All deputies entering the water or working near the water shall wear a properly secured personal flotation device (PFD).

3. If a victim has fallen through the ice, deputies should establish and maintain communication with the victim, if possible.

a) Deputies should not attempt to go onto the ice without proper training and equipment.

b) Deputies may attempt to reach the victim utilizing rope or other objects.

4. Deputies should attempt to determine the exact location of the victim(s) or the last known location. Deputies should also attempt to determine the number of victims, how long the victim(s) has been in the water, and the

condition of the victim. All information should be relayed to Communications for dissemination to responding agencies.

5. The shift supervisor should ensure the appropriate jurisdictional fire department and rescue squad have been notified. The shift supervisor should also request the Bellevue Fire Department, the Omaha Fire Department, or Papillion Fire Department for water rescue assistance.

6. The shift supervisor should place an emergency medical helicopter on standby (see P-3432 Emergency Medical Helicopter).